

# Juan Pablo Durango Cardona

(Juan-P. Durango; Juan P. Durango; Durango J.P.; Cardona J.P.D.)

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## Contact information

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## Professional profile

I am a biologist from EAFIT University with an interest in the taxonomy, systematics, natural history, and conservation of amphibians and reptiles. My research focuses on anuran bioacoustics and its applications in taxonomy and systematics. I have experience in environmental consulting, conducting fauna inventories for biodiversity loss offsets, environmental impact assessments, and the establishment of conservation areas. I also have experience in teaching, working with biological collections, laboratory techniques, species identification via third- and next-generation sequencing, and the analysis of ecological, acoustic, and morphological data.

## Education

**Universidad EAFIT**

*B.Sc. in Biology*

Medellín, Antioquia, Colombia

06/2016 – 04/2024

## Scholarships & Awards

**Ser Pilo Paga**

*Government of Colombia*

11/2015

- Conditional loan program to finance university degrees in accredited high-quality institutions for the country's best low-income students.

**Mini Grant Program**

*EvoBio Crash Course*

12/2024

~206.88 USD

- Support to overcome a tangible barrier when applying for or accessing the next stage of training in evolutionary biology.

## Skills

### Hard skills

- **Languages** : Spanish (Native), English (C1 - IELTS), Portuguese (A1) and German (A1)
- **Molecular** : DNA extraction, amplification (PCR), quantification and sequencing (Oxford Nanopore).
- **Field** : Pitfall traps, auditory band transects, linear transects, acoustic monitoring. Snake handling and relocation.

### Computational skills

- **Bioinformatics** : Geneious, Garli, BEAST
- **Office** : Microsoft Office (Word, Excel, PowerPoint), LibreOffice
- **Creative** : Gimp, Adobe Premiere, Adobe Lightroom, Adobe Photoshop
- **Programming** : R, Matlab, Python, shell scripting (Linux/Unix), LATEX,
- **Others** : Raven, Audacity, ArcGIS, QGIS, MaxENT

## Research experience

**Young researcher**

**Advisor:** Juan Fernando Diaz Nieto

01/08/2024 – 31/07/2025

*Sustainability and Systems Area, Universidad EAFIT*

Medellín, Antioquia, Colombia

- **Project:** DNA barcoding of small mammals from Colombia using **Oxford Nanopore Sequencing Technologies**.

## Teaching experience

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### Part-time Lecture

*Vice-Rectorate for Outreach, ITM*

21/07/2026 – 30/08/2026  
Medellín, Antioquia, Colombia

- Support for the learning process in biology and natural sciences.

### Part-time Lecture

*Vice-Rectorate for Outreach, ITM*

10/06/2026 – 30/06/2026  
Medellín, Antioquia, Colombia

- Support for the learning process in biology and natural sciences.

## Experience

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### Biological technical consultancy

*eQual SAS*

03/2026 – 04/2026  
On-site – Chinú, Córdoba, Colombia

- **Amphibian and reptile community characterization** for an environmental impact assessment (EIA) supporting environmental licensing.

### Biological technical consultancy

*CGA SAS*

01/2026 – 02/2026  
On-site – Arauca, Arauca, Colombia

- **Amphibian and reptile community characterization** to update the environmental management plan for airport modernization and expansion.

### Biological technical consultancy

*Universidad EAFIT*

11/21/2025 – 01/31/2026  
On-site – Segovia, Antioquia, Colombia

- **Amphibian and reptile community** characterization for the registration of private lands as a Civil Society Natural Reserve.

### Biological technical consultancy

*INGEOVITAL ESTUDIOS AMBIENTALES S.A.S.*

07/2025 – 08/2025  
On-site – Remedios/Segovia, Antioquia, Colombia

- **Amphibian and reptile community characterization** for an environmental impact assessment (EIA) supporting environmental licensing.

### Biological technical consultancy

*Universidad EAFIT*

08/01/2025 – 08/31/2025  
On-site – Medellín, Antioquia, Colombia

- Glossary, bibliography, and table preparation for the book **Guide to the Herps of the Colombian Pacific**.

### Young researcher

*Universidad EAFIT*

08/01/2024 – 07/31/2025  
On-site – Medellín, Antioquia, Colombia

- DNA extraction, amplification (PCR), quantification and sequencing with **Oxford Nanopore Technologies** of small mammals, plants, and amphibians.
- Consolidation of the Network of territorial spaces and actors of the Museum of Natural and Cultural History of Colombia, at the national level. Partner institutions: Jardín Botánico "Guillermo Piñeres" Foundation, Universidad de los Andes, Alexander von Humboldt Biological Resources Research Institute, International Center for Tropical Agriculture - CIAT, Amazonian Scientific Research Institute - SINCHI, Universidad Pontificia Bolivariana, Universidad EAFIT.

### Biological technical consultancy

*+ Verde S.A.S. BIC*

03/2025 – 03/2025  
On-site – San Cayetano, Norte de Santander, Colombia

- **Amphibian and reptile community characterization** for an environmental impact assessment (EIA) supporting environmental licensing.

### Biological technical consultancy

*Marine & Port Consultants S.A.S.*

12/2024 – 12/2024  
On-site – Guapi, Cauca, Colombia

- **Wildlife rescue and relocation** during the decommissioning phase of an infrastructure project.

### Biological technical consultancy

*CONSGA S.A.S.*

07/2024 – 08/2024  
On-site – Palestina, Santander, Colombia

- **Amphibian and reptile community characterization** for an environmental impact assessment (EIA) supporting environmental licensing.

- Biological technical consultancy** 01/2024 – 02/2024  
INGEOVITAL ESTUDIOS AMBIENTALES S.A.S. On-site – Remedios, Antioquia, Colombia
- **Amphibian and reptile community characterization** for an environmental impact assessment (EIA) supporting environmental licensing.
- Biological technical consultancy** 11/15/2023 – 11/30/2023  
Universidad EAFIT On-site – Tamesis, Antioquia, Colombia
- Research assistant for mammal monitoring at **El Globo cloud forest Habitat Bank**.
- Biological technical consultancy** 03/2023 – 04/2023  
INGEOVITAL ESTUDIOS AMBIENTALES S.A.S. On-site – Segovia, Antioquia, Colombia
- **Amphibian and reptile community characterization** for an environmental impact assessment (EIA) supporting environmental licensing.
- Educational internships** 06/2022 – 11/2022  
De Costa a Costa On-site – Bahía Solano, Chocó, Colombia
- **Educational internships** in ecotourism with an emphasis on whale watching.
  - **Guided walks** along trails with nature interpretation with emphasis on **Amphibians and Reptiles**.
  - **Basic inventory of Fauna and Flora** of the facilities and trails.
- Biological technical consultancy** 09/2022 – 09/2022  
CyC CONSULTORES AMBIENTALES S.A.S. Remote – Medellín, Antioquia, Colombia
- Specialized **bat acoustic data analysis** service for environmental management plans.
- Biological technical consultancy** 04/18/2022 – 04/30/2022  
Universidad EAFIT On-site – Medellín, Antioquia, Colombia
- **DNA extraction** from cacao seeds for metagenomic analysis.
- Biological technical consultancy** 07/09/2021 – 12/31/2021  
INSTITUTO TECNOLÓGICO METROPOLITANO - ITM Remote – Medellín, Antioquia, Colombia
- Specialized **bat acoustic data analysis** service for environmental management plans.
- Biological technical consultancy** 03/01/2021 – 03/31/2021  
Universidad EAFIT On-site – Amalfi, Antioquia, Colombia
- **Amphibian and reptile community characterization**, to establish conservation areas.
- Educational services provision** 09/05/2019 – 03/18/2021  
INSTITUTO TECNOLÓGICO METROPOLITANO - ITM On-site – Medellín, Antioquia, Colombia
- Support in designing services and public engagement for the educational program of the Science Center, Museo de Ciencias Naturales de La Salle.
- Academic monitoring** 02/2020 – 03/2020  
STEP Project On-site – Bahía Solano, Chocó, Colombia
- **Field assistant for the herpetofauna** characterization of a community in the Colombian Chocó, to support scientific tourism.
- Academic monitoring** 06/18/2018 – 06/23/2018  
Clubes de Ciencia Colombia On-site – Medellín, Antioquia, Colombia
- Support in the development of laboratory activities and advising of high school students.

**Publications** (†principal author, ‡equal contribution, §secondary contribution)

**Citations (Google scholar)**

June 2026

**Total [5] | h-index [1]**

**Published**

9. Durango, J.P.<sup>†</sup> & Arredondo, J.C. (2026). On the type locality of *Andinobates opisthomelas* (Boulenger, 1899) and *Colostethus pratti* (Boulenger, 1899), with a redescription of *A. opisthomelas* based on newly collected topotypes. *South American Journal of Herpetology*, 38(1): 45–60. <https://doi.org/10.2994/SAJH-D-24-00004.1>
8. Garzón-Franco, E., Durango, J.P.<sup>‡</sup> & Arredondo, J.C. (2026). Predation of the Chocoan robber frog, *Strabomantis anomalus* (Strabomantidae), by a Cat-eyed snake, *Leptodeira ornata* (Dipsadidae) in the Colombian Chocó. *Revista Latinoamericana De Herpetología*, 9(1), e1388: 173–176. <https://doi.org/10.22201/fc.25942158e.2026.1.1388>
7. Lozano-Arias, J.M., Gómez-Mesa, L., Durango, J.P.<sup>‡</sup>, & Garzón-Franco, E. (2026). Hidden in the leaf litter: rediscovery and morphological variation of the largescale lizard, *Alopoglossus grandisquamatus* (Rueda, 1985) (Squamata: Alopoglossidae). *Zootaxa*, 5757(4): 369–381. <https://doi.org/10.11646/zootaxa.5757.4.5>
6. Garzón-Franco, E., Durango, J.P.<sup>‡</sup>, Ospina-Sarria, J.J. & Arredondo, J.C. (2026). A new species of *Pristimantis* (Anura: Strabomantidae) from the western slope of the Serranía del Baudó, Chocó, Colombia. *Zootaxa*, 5757(4): 301–323. <https://doi.org/10.11646/zootaxa.5757.4.1>
5. Vargas-Ramirez, Y.C., Garzón-Franco, E., & Durango, J.P.<sup>‡</sup> (2025). New distributional records of the endemic rainfrog *Pristimantis blasi* Duarte–Marín, Montoya–Marín & Rivera–Gómez (Anura, Strabomantidae), towards the Chocó of Colombia. *Revista Latinoamericana De Herpetología*, 8(1), e1114: 143–147. <https://doi.org/10.22201/fc.25942158e.2025.1.1114>
4. Durango, J.P.<sup>†</sup> (2025). The Advertisement Call of the Santa Marta robber frog *Serranobatrachus sanctaemartae* (Ruthven 1917). *The Herpetological Bulletin*, 171: 30–32. <https://doi.org/10.33256/hb171.3032>
3. Durango, J.P.<sup>†</sup> (2024). The Distress Call of *Smilisca phaeota* (Cope 1862) (Hylidae: Hylinae) during manipulation. *Reptiles & Amphibians*, 31: e2186. <https://doi.org/10.17161/randa.v31i1.21860>
2. Durango, J.P.<sup>†</sup>, Garzón-Franco, E., Gómez-Mesa, L., Lozano-Arias, J.M., Guayasamin, J.M. & Arredondo, J.C. (2024). Geographic call variation in the Granular Glassfrog *Cochranella granulosa* (Taylor, 1949) (Anura, Centrolenidae) and a new distribution record in Colombia. *Herpetology Notes*, 17: 587–595. <https://www.biotaxa.org/hn/article/view/85050>
1. Durango, J.P.<sup>†</sup>, Garzón-Franco, E., Castellanos-Mejía, M.C. & Arredondo, J.C. (2022). Predation by a Cope's False Coralsnake, *Pliocercus euryzonus* (Cope 1862) (Dipsadidae), on a catfish (Trichomycteridae: *Trichomycterus*) in the northern Andes of Colombia. *Reptiles & Amphibians*, 29: 95–97. <https://doi.org/10.17161/randa.v29i1.16256>

**In preparation**

- Durango, J.P. & Arredondo, J.C. (*In prep*). Advertisement call, tadpole morphology and other natural history notes of *Leucostethus dysprosium* (Rivero and Serna, 2000).
- Durango, J.P. & Grant, T. (*In prep*). The systematics of *Colostethus pratti* (Anura, Dendrobatoidea).
- Garzón-Franco, E., Durango, J.P., Vargas-Ramirez, Y.C., & Lozano-Arias, J.M. (*In prep*). A new species related to *Pristimantis labiosus* (Anura, Craugastoridae), from Chocó, Colombia.

**Peer-reviewer work**

- The Herpetological Bulletin, UK

**Conferences, fairs and meetings**

**IV Colombian Congress of Herpetology**

Universidad del Magdalena

12/01/2025 – 12/06/2025

On-site – Santa Marta, Magdalena, Colombia

- **Oral presentation:** Delimitation and redescription of *Andinobates opisthomelas* (Boulenger, 1899).
- **Oral presentation:** Larval development and additional natural history notes of *Leucostethus dysprosium* (Dendrobatoidea: Colostethinae).
- **Poster:** Local science: importance of a local vision in the systematics of the *Colostethus pratti* complex.

**II Colombian Congress of Bioacoustics and Ecoacoustics**

Parque Explora

11/18/2024 – 11/22/2024

On-site – Medellín, Antioquia, Colombia

- **Organizing assistant**

### III Colombian Congress of Herpetology

Universidad ICESI

07/31/2022 – 08/05/2022

On-site – Cali, Valle del Cauca, Colombia

- **Oral presentation:** Clarification of the type locality of *Andinobates opisthomelas* and *Colostethus pratti* with comments on the taxonomic identity of *A. opisthomelas*

### XVI Departmental Meeting of Research Incubator

Universidad de Antioquia

05/18/2017 – 05/20/2017

On-site – Medellín, Antioquia, Colombia

- **Poster**

### XVII Departmental Meeting of Research Incubator

Institución Universitaria de Envigado

05/09/2018 – 05/11/2018

On-site – Medellín, Antioquia, Colombia

- **Poster**

### Research Incubator Fair

Universidad EAFIT

10/04/2018 – 10/05/2018

On-site – Medellín, Antioquia, Colombia

- **Poster**

### Research groups

#### Biodiversity Research Seedbed

School of Applied Sciences and Engineering, Universidad EAFIT

06/2018 – Present

#### Reinventing Research Seedbed

La Salle Natural Sciences Museum - ITM

06/2018 – Present

### References

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